

er technology, mainframes contain multiple CPUs running into dozens, have thousands of GB of RAM, and high-speed hard disk subsystems that can hold terabytes of data. Mainframes have a Mean Time Between Failure (MTBF) rating of 20 years. Of late, interest in mainframes is being revived.

8.3.15 Milestone

In project management terminology, a milestone is a key event or task. The completion of this task will signal that the project has completed some important segment of the project. Each project can have multiple milestones.

8.3.16 Outsourcing

Taking internal company functions and asking an outside agency to do it. This may be due to cost advantages or because the company may not have the required skills or manpower.

8.3.17 Project Management Office

When an organisation has more than one major IT project being implemented, it becomes imperative that the processes be well-documented and the projects co-ordinated to ensure that there is no overlap and that there will not be any conflicts of personality or even data. The project management office provides a formal mechanism by which multiple projects may be co-ordinated and implemented in a structured and organised manner.

8.3.18 Remote Access

Accessing a remote computer and taking control over a computer as if you were sitting at it and using its mouse and keyboard. In Windows, such access is provided by RDP—Remote Desktop Protocol. Using RDP (which the user is unaware of, by the way) a user can request for assistance from a colleague or friend or from the organisation's help desk. The help desk technician connects to the user's Desktop, takes over control, and rectifies the problem as if he were sitting at the user's workstation. He then hands back control to the user and disconnects the session. While Windows uses RDP, Linux uses VNC or Virtual Network Computing to